

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Hugh Bidder

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

- Buys art for **Elon Mosaic**. **Elon** likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.
- **Penny Pincher** asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.
- Keeps offering to represent **Vincent Van Faux**. **Vincent** wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Hugh Bidder. Everything has a price. My charming conversation is the only exception, and even that is negotiable.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Hugh Bidder

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Your other secret

You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Saul D. Bid knows about the disputed certificate.
- Keep Elon Mosaic from discussing the 'auction incident' in public.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A seat with a cold metallic skeleton keeps its secret underneath.*
- 2 *A little door hides shelves and, tonight, a secret.*
- 3 *A book beginning with creation has a secret between its pages.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The certificate was forged before it reached me. I then altered my file to hide how badly I had been fooled. Grant intended to call that a forgery of my own unless I refunded millions. My professional judgment was poor. His price for keeping quiet was excellent, for him.

IF MURDERER

I altered my file after discovering the certificate was false. Grant wanted millions back and a public admission that I had created the forgery. He knew that wasn't true. He preferred an expensive villain to a complicated transaction, especially when he could make the villain pay twice.



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ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.

IF MURDERER

I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.



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Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I first entered at 6:29, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt records that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it.

IF MURDERER

I first entered at 6:17, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt documents that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my settlement envelope. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass out of the way of the offer.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Hugh Bidder

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Hugh Bidder

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The certificate was already false when I received it. Altering my file afterward was my decision. I entered at 6:29, after the bottle had been locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will give the buyer the unaltered correspondence and negotiate the refund without pretending a changed file repairs the sale.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my settlement envelope when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He could expose the false certificate and destroy my business. I chose murder over admitting it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.